



Our Indian competitors at the WorldSkills Competition 2024 showcase India's opportunity to be the global skilling hub

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Our WorldSkills India Team has done us proud as they returned from Lyon, France with 4 bronze medals and 12 medallions of excellence, finishing 13th out of over 70 nations. Our contingents' personal stories and effort are a perfect foundation for India to continue its journey to be the global skilling hub, and optimize our demographic dividend. A competition of this magnitude and the outcomes our competitors have achieved is what makes role models and will help broad-base and normalize excellence in one's craft at a population scale. This is truly exciting, and we have to set up all the enabling frameworks to make this a reality. The WorldSkills competition is a showcase for what India is capable of, as we prioritize skilling, and look at making India the global skills hub. It is also indicative of just how much talent and opportunity there is to achieve these goals. There is also a larger lesson to take home- the degree of collaboration, and the unerring support of several of our industry partners to enhance and hone the performance



ability of participants, is truly worth celebrating. It also showcases the potential for public private partnerships at a population scale for making India the skilling hub of the world. Over time, India should also be in the running to host major events such as WorldSkills, along with several innovative domestic interventions that are in the pipeline. First however, it's important to learn about some of our champions' journeys. Tufan Mal, from Hawada

in West Bengal discovered his calling to jewellery design at a young age, finding his passion in subtle and intricate details and craftsmanship of fine pieces. With his father working as a self-employed car mechanic, Tufan's origins showed him the importance of nurturing ambitions, and his journey is a story of sheer determination. The support of his family gave him not only the confidence but also the deeply entrenched desire